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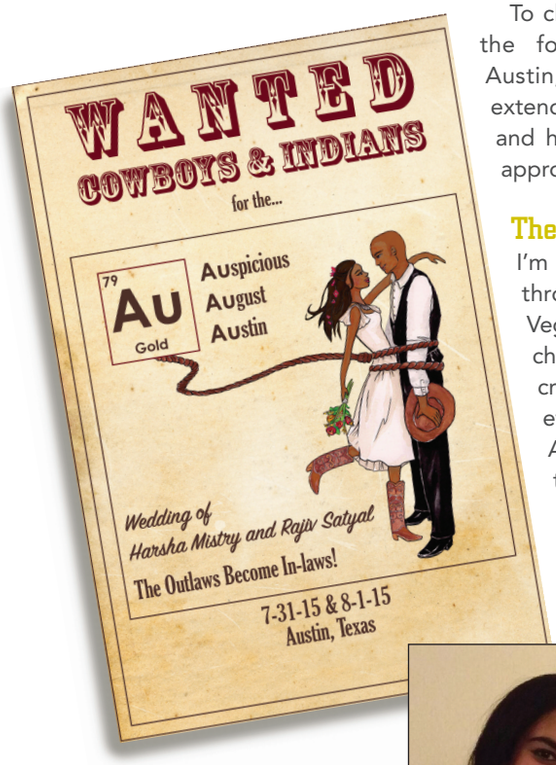
parents back to join us — and Harsha touched their feet! It's an Indian tradition, but the way she did it was so... touching.

To close the loop with God, we did the formal Hindu engagement in Austin, where I met some of her extended family and her brother Jatin and his wife Deepti. Fortunately, we approved of each other.



The Bachelor Party

I'm going with the original idea of throwing my bachelor party in Vegas. Given how much my life has changed, I don't have much of a crew anymore, so I'm including every man invited to the wedding. And my friends have told me it's totally kosher (or halal) to invite guys even if they're not invited to the wedding.

The worst time to throw a bachelor party is after you get engaged. I'm headed to Vegas with all my boys and I can't even hook up. We should change the convention so that it's more like a lifeline on "Who Wants to Be a Millionaire?" At your darkest moment, when all hope is lost and you're afraid you'll never get married, you call up your best friend and tell him you need a bachelor party. I have a girl friend (note the space) who, after years of being single, threw herself a housewarming party and even registered. "Why should married people get all the gifts?" she reasoned. Good for her. Come to think of it, she should be the main character in that aforementioned romantic comedy.

One Little, Two Little Indians in Texas

The Wedding

We're in full swing with wedding planning. Given that I perform at all sorts of gatherings, I've been to a TON of Indian weddings. Of course, I'm looking to make mine different. Everybody does (which is why you should hire me to perform at... but I digress).

At the beginning of the process, we asked our friends how to go about wedding planning. Just about everybody had a one-word answer: "Elope." I liked the idea, because it's the only thing I can think of that's both romantic and cheap.

Alas, we find ourselves in the midst of it. And to be honest, I'm enjoying every moment of it. One of the most stressful things a couple will do in their lives is plan a wedding. And if you're marrying the right person, you'll know fairly early on. I've lucked out (which you already know just by looking at her) in that she's been a joy. We've collaborated on everything thus far. Of course, most of it still falls on her, given that it's taking place in her town of Austin. (And she's just a nicer person.)

The Specifics

• **Invitations:** I'd love to post the list of invitees on Facebook, like football tryouts — see if you made the cut. That's not going to happen, but we're going to tell people who in their circle is invited so they don't make the dreaded *faux pas* of asking non-invitees if they're going.

• **Food:** We're doing Tex Mex for lunch and a buffet for dinner. Plated dinners are so stupid. Why would everybody eat the same amount of food? It's like telling everybody to drink eight cups of water a day. Some people are 80 pounds and others are 300. It makes no sense.

• **Ceremony:** We're trying to hold the ceremony to an hour. In India, everything is longer — Indian weddings are longer than American weddings. Indian last names tend to be the longest on the planet. Bollywood movies are longer than Hollywood ones. Indian weddings are so long that we're the only people who walk out of a Catholic wedding and say, "Boy, that was fast."

• **Music:** This is the one item into which I'm pouring 80% of my effort. Harsha and I see eye-to-eye on most music and we need the right blend of Michael Jackson, Bollywood, Disco, Garth Brooks, Beastie Boys, Nirvana and Ke$ha.

• **Themes:** We're all about the jokes. She's a pharmacist and I'm a comedian, so our theme is "Laughter Is The Best Medicine." With jokes like these, I'm clearly ready to be an Indian Uncle. That works out, because Jatin and Deepti have twins on the way. In comedy, timing is everything.

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